John 7 - 9

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Prophecy Fulfilled (WEB)

Three chapters at one feast.

It is Tabernacles - Sukkot - the most joyful week of the year. The whole nation living in booths, waving branches, remembering the wilderness, and pouring out water and lighting lamps in the temple courts.

And His own brothers do not believe in Him.

Go up and show Yourself, they say. He says My time has not yet come - and then He goes up quietly, halfway through the week, and starts teaching in the temple.

The whole city is arguing about Him. He is a good man. No, He is leading the people astray. Is this the Christ? Can the Christ come from Galilee?

Then on the last and greatest day of the feast He stands up and shouts.

If anyone is thirsty, let him come to Me and drink.

The officers sent to arrest Him come back empty-handed and say the only thing they can say. No one ever spoke like this man.

Then a woman dragged into the temple court, and a crowd holding stones, and a question meant to trap Him.

And He bends down and writes in the dirt with His finger.

The same finger that wrote on the stone tablets on the mountain.

Let the one without sin throw the first stone. And one by one, oldest first, they all walk away.

Then: I am the light of the world - said in the very court where the giant lamps of the feast were lit.

Then the longest argument in the Gospel. Who is your father? Abraham. Then do what Abraham did. We were never slaves to anyone. Truth will make you free.

And it ends with the sentence that sends them reaching for stones.

Before Abraham was, I AM.

Then a man born blind, sitting by the road. Who sinned, this man or his parents?

Neither.

Mud from spit and dust, a pool called Sent, and a man who comes back seeing - and then gets thrown out of the synagogue for it.

One thing I know. I was blind, and now I see.

And at the end of the chapter it is the man who could not see who is worshipping, and the men who could see who are blind.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 7 - Brothers Who Did Not Believe, a Shout on the Last Day, and Rivers of Living Water

Key Notes

- He stayed in Galilee because the Judeans were looking to kill Him. Chapter 5 ended with a death plot, and it is still in the air (John 7:1, 5:18).
- Tabernacles was the feast of tents, seven days of rejoicing after the harvest was in, with the whole household - servants, foreigners, widows and orphans included - living in booths. It was the most crowded week of the year in Jerusalem (John 7:2, Leviticus 23:34, Deuteronomy 16:13-14).
- “Even his brothers didn’t believe in him.” These are the brothers who grew up in the same house. One of them, James, later led the assembly in Jerusalem and wrote a letter in the New Testament. Unbelief at the dinner table is not the end of the story (John 7:5, 1 Corinthians 15:7).
- Their advice is pure public relations: nobody does things in secret if he wants to be known, so show yourself to the world. It is the same logic as the wilderness temptation - prove it in public (John 7:3-4).
- “My time has not yet come” is a different word from “my hour.” It means the right moment, the opportune season. Theirs, He says, is always ready, because nothing they do costs them anything (John 7:6).
- “I am not yet going up to this feast” - and then He goes. Some manuscripts read “not yet,” others simply “not.” Either way He refuses to go on their terms, as a public show, and goes later on His own (John 7:8-10).
- The crowd murmurs, which is the wilderness word again, and is split between “he is a good man” and “he leads the multitude astray.” Nobody says it out loud, for fear (John 7:12-13).
- “How does this man know letters, having never been educated?” He had not studied under a recognised rabbi. They meant: where did He get His authority? He answers: from the one who sent Me (John 7:15-16).
- “If anyone desires to do his will, he will know about the teaching.” Obedience comes before understanding here, not after it. You find out whether it is true by being willing to do it (John 7:17).
- “Didn’t Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keeps the law?” He is not attacking the Torah. He is accusing them of breaking it, by plotting murder while defending the Sabbath (John 7:19).
- Circumcision on the eighth day went ahead even when the eighth day fell on a Sabbath, because the instruction about the eighth day came first. His argument: if you can perform a covenant act on one part of a man on the Sabbath, why be angry that I made the whole man well? (John 7:22-23, Leviticus 12:3).

- “Don’t judge according to appearance, but judge righteous judgment” is almost a quotation of Deuteronomy 16, the charge given to every judge in Israel (John 7:24, Deuteronomy 16:18).
- “When the Christ comes, no one will know where he comes from” reflects an expectation that the Messiah would appear suddenly and unknown. They think they know where He is from. They are only half right (John 7:27-28).
- “Where I am, you can’t come” is said to His enemies here, and later to His friends at the last supper - with a promise added for the friends that is not given to the enemies (John 7:34, 13:33, 14:3).
- “The dispersion among the Greeks” means the Jews living scattered across the Greek-speaking world. They mean it as a sneer. John’s readers knew the message did exactly that (John 7:35).
- The last and greatest day of the feast is either the seventh day, when the water ceremony reached its height, or the eighth day, the solemn assembly Moses added to the end. Readers have argued both for a long time. The Torah gives the eighth day its own holy convocation (John 7:37, Leviticus 23:36).
- Each morning of Tabernacles, a priest carried water from the pool of Siloam up to the temple and poured it out at the altar while the people sang. That ceremony is described in later Jewish writings rather than in the Torah, but it is the background that makes the shout land: on that day, at that feast, He offers water (John 7:37, Isaiah 12:3).
- “He stood and cried out” - teachers normally sat. This was a man standing up in the temple court and shouting (John 7:37).
- “As the Scripture has said” points to no single verse. The nearest are Zechariah 14, living waters going out from Jerusalem, and Ezekiel 47, water flowing from under the threshold of the temple - both prophecies associated with this very feast (John 7:38, Zechariah 14:8, Ezekiel 47:1).
- “From within him” can be read two ways: out of the believer, or out of the Messiah Himself. John’s next sentence, about the Spirit, suggests the source is Him and the channel is us (John 7:38-39).
- “The Holy Spirit was not yet given, because Jesus wasn’t yet glorified.” John is writing from the far side of the cross, and he tells you so (John 7:39).
- Some in the crowd object that the Christ comes from Bethlehem, of the seed of David. John reports it without comment - because every one of his readers knew where He was born (John 7:42, Micah 5:2).
- “No man ever spoke like this man!” The officers were sent to arrest Him and came back arrested by what they heard (John 7:46).
- “This multitude that doesn’t know the law is cursed.” The leaders’ contempt for ordinary people is said out loud (John 7:49).
- Nicodemus, who came by night in chapter 3, now speaks up in daylight, on a point of Torah: do we judge a man before hearing him? It is a small step, and it costs him (John 7:50-51, Deuteronomy 1:16-17).

- “No prophet has arisen out of Galilee” is simply not true. Jonah was from Gath Hepher, a town in Galilee in the territory of Zebulun. In their anger the experts forgot their own Scriptures (John 7:52, 2 Kings 14:25).
- The story of the woman taken in adultery, which follows, is missing from the earliest Greek manuscripts of John and turns up in different places in later ones. Most readers believe it is a true story about Yahshua, preserved separately; the WEB prints it here (John 7:53).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
The Feast of Tents	John 7:2 • Leviticus 23:34 • Deuteronomy 16:13-14
Willing to Do His Will	John 7:17 • Psalm 25:14 • Deuteronomy 29:29
Circumcision on the Eighth Day	John 7:22 • Genesis 17:12 • Leviticus 12:3
Judge With Righteous Judgment	John 7:24 • Deuteronomy 16:18-19 • Leviticus 19:15
The Last Day of the Feast	John 7:37 • Leviticus 23:36 • Numbers 29:35
Come to the Waters	John 7:37 • Isaiah 55:1 • Isaiah 12:3
A Hearing Before Judgment	John 7:51 • Deuteronomy 1:16-17 • Deuteronomy 17:4
A Prophet From Galilee	John 7:52 • 2 Kings 14:25 • Joshua 19:13

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
A Stranger to His Brothers	John 7:5 • Psalm 69:8 • Genesis 37:4
The Teaching of the One Who Sent Him	John 7:16 • Deuteronomy 18:18 • Isaiah 11:2
Rivers of Living Water	John 7:38 • Zechariah 14:8 • Ezekiel 47:1
The Spirit Poured Out	John 7:39 • Joel 2:28 • Isaiah 44:3
The Prophet	John 7:40 • Deuteronomy 18:15
From Bethlehem, of the Seed of David	John 7:42 • Micah 5:2 • 2 Samuel 7:12
Grace Poured on His Lips	John 7:46 • Psalm 45:2 • Isaiah 50:4

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 7 Commentary (David Guzik) - the Feast of Tabernacles, the division over Yahshua, and rivers of living water
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John’s signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three

- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 7A - exposition of Yahshua at the Feast of Tabernacles

John 7 - Opening Intro

This chapter is set at Sukkot. The Feast of Tabernacles. And if you have ever kept it, you know it is the happiest week on the calendar.

The harvest is in. The whole family moves out into booths. You wave the branches, you rejoice before Yahweh, you remember that your fathers lived in tents in the wilderness and He took care of them the whole way.

And the chapter opens with His own brothers mocking Him.

Go on up to Judea. Let your disciples see what you can do. Nobody who wants to be famous does things in secret.

And John just says it flat out: even His brothers did not believe in Him.

Now think about that. These are the boys He grew up with. Same house. Same table. And they did not believe.

And I want you to hold onto this, because some of you have family who do not believe either. One of those brothers was James. And James ended up leading the assembly in Jerusalem and writing a book of the Bible. Unbelief at the dinner table is not the end of the story.

He says to them: My time has not yet come. Your time is always ready - because nothing you do costs you anything.

And then He goes up to the feast quietly, on His own terms, not as a show.

And the whole city is talking about Him in whispers. He is a good man. No - He is leading the people astray. And nobody will say it out loud, because they are afraid.

Then halfway through the week, He walks into the temple and starts teaching. And the experts are stunned. How does this man know all this? He never studied under anybody.

And He says: My teaching is not Mine. It belongs to the One who sent Me. And if anybody is willing to do His will, he will know whether this teaching is from God.

Hear that. You find out if it is true by being willing to obey it. Not the other way around.

And then He goes on the attack. Did not Moses give you the instructions? And not one of you keeps them. Why are you trying to kill Me?

And He makes the argument that every Sabbath-keeper should know. You circumcise a baby on the Sabbath, because the eighth day comes first. You will do a covenant act on one part of a man on the Sabbath - and you are angry with Me for making the whole man well?

Do not judge by appearances. Judge with righteous judgment. That is Deuteronomy 16, word for word, the charge given to every judge in Israel.

And then we get to the last day. The great day of the feast.

Now, every morning that week, a priest would go down to the pool of Siloam with a golden pitcher, carry the water up to the temple, and pour it out at the altar while the crowd sang from Isaiah: with joy you will draw water from the wells of salvation.

And on the last day, in the middle of all that, Yahshua stands up - teachers sat down to teach, so He is standing - and He shouts.

If anyone is thirsty, let him come to Me and drink. Whoever believes in Me, out of his belly will flow rivers of living water.

That is Zechariah 14 - living waters going out from Jerusalem. That is Ezekiel 47 - a river flowing out from under the temple. And both of those are Tabernacles prophecies.

He is standing in the temple at the water feast saying: the river you are singing about? It comes out of Me.

And John tells us what He meant. He was talking about the Spirit, which had not been given yet.

And the crowd splits right down the middle. This is the Prophet. This is the Christ. No - the Christ comes from Bethlehem.

And John does not even bother to answer that one. He knows you know where He was born.

Meanwhile the temple police were sent to arrest Him. And they come back with nothing. Why did you not bring Him? And their answer is one of the great lines in the Gospel. No man ever spoke like this man.

And the leaders explode. Have you been deceived too? This mob does not know the instructions - they are cursed.

And then one man speaks up. Nicodemus. The one who came by night. And all he says is: does our Torah condemn a man without hearing him first?

It is not much. But it is in daylight.

And they turn on him too. Are you from Galilee? Search and see - no prophet comes out of Galilee.

Which is just false. Jonah was from Gath Hepher, in Galilee. They were so angry they forgot their own Bible.

Before we read - notice how many people in this chapter are afraid to say what they think, and how many people stand up anyway. His brothers did not believe. The officers came back amazed. Nicodemus finally spoke. Which one are you this week?

John 7:1-53 (WEB)

1 After these things, Jesus was walking in Galilee, for he wouldn't walk in Judea, because the Jews sought to kill him.

2 Now the feast of the Jews, the Feast of Booths, was at hand.[1]

3 His brothers therefore said to him, "Depart from here, and go into Judea, that your disciples also may see your works which you do.

4 For no one does anything in secret, and himself seeks to be known openly. If you do these things, reveal yourself to the world."

5 For even his brothers didn't believe in him.[2]

6 Jesus therefore said to them, "My time has not yet come, but your time is always ready.

7 The world can't hate you, but it hates me, because I testify about it, that its works are evil.

8 You go up to the feast. I am not yet going up to this feast, because my time is not yet fulfilled."

9 Having said these things to them, he stayed in Galilee.

10 But when his brothers had gone up to the feast, then he also went up, not publicly, but as it were in secret.

11 The Jews therefore sought him at the feast, and said, "Where is he?"

12 There was much murmuring among the multitudes concerning him. Some said, "He is a good man." Others said, "Not so, but he leads the multitude astray."

13 Yet no one spoke openly of him for fear of the Jews.

14 But when it was now the middle of the feast, Jesus went up into the temple and taught.

15 The Jews therefore marveled, saying, "How does this man know letters, having never been educated?"

16 Jesus therefore answered them, "My teaching is not mine, but his who sent me.[3]

17 If anyone desires to do his will, he will know about the teaching, whether it is from God, or if I am speaking from myself.[4]

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[1] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:34 • Deuteronomy 16:13-14 - *the feast of tents for seven days in the seventh month, kept with rejoicing by the whole household and the stranger*

[2] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 69:8 • Genesis 37:4 - *a stranger to my brothers and an alien to my mother's children, and Joseph's brothers who could not speak peaceably to him*

[3] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:18 • Isaiah 11:2 - *my words in his mouth, and he shall speak all that I command him, and the Spirit of wisdom and understanding resting on him*

[4] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 25:14 • Deuteronomy 29:29 - *the friendship of Yahweh is with those who fear him, and the things revealed belong to us, that we may do all the words*

18 He who speaks from himself seeks his own glory, but he who seeks the glory of him who sent him is true, and no unrighteousness is in him.

19 Didn't Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keeps the law? Why do you seek to kill me?"

20 The multitude answered, "You have a demon! Who seeks to kill you?"

21 Jesus answered them, "I did one work, and you all marvel because of it.

22 Moses has given you circumcision (not that it is of Moses, but of the fathers), and on the Sabbath you circumcise a boy.[5]

23 If a boy receives circumcision on the Sabbath, that the law of Moses may not be broken, are you angry with me, because I made a man completely healthy on the Sabbath?

24 Don't judge according to appearance, but judge righteous judgment."[6]

25 Therefore some of them of Jerusalem said, "Isn't this he whom they seek to kill?

26 Behold, he speaks openly, and they say nothing to him. Can it be that the rulers indeed know that this is truly the Christ?

27 However we know where this man comes from, but when the Christ comes, no one will know where he comes from."

28 Jesus therefore cried out in the temple, teaching and saying, "You both know me, and know where I am from. I have not come of myself, but he who sent me is true, whom you don't know.

29 I know him, because I am from him, and he sent me."

30 They sought therefore to take him; but no one laid a hand on him, because his hour had not yet come.

31 But of the multitude, many believed in him. They said, "When the Christ comes, he won't do more signs than those which this man has done, will he?"

32 The Pharisees heard the multitude murmuring these things concerning him, and the chief priests and the Pharisees sent officers to arrest him.

33 Then Jesus said, "I will be with you a little while longer, then I go to him who sent me.

34 You will seek me, and won't find me; and where I am, you can't come."

35 The Jews therefore said among themselves, "Where will this man go that we won't find him? Will he go to the Dispersion among the Greeks, and teach the Greeks?

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[5] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 17:12 • Leviticus 12:3 - *every male circumcised at eight days old, on the eighth day*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 16:18-19 • Leviticus 19:15 - *judges who judge the people with righteous judgment and show no partiality, judging your neighbor in righteousness*

36 What is this word that he said, ‘You will seek me, and won’t find me; and where I am, you can’t come’?”

37 Now on the last and greatest day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried out, “If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink![7]

38 He who believes in me, as the Scripture has said, from within him will flow rivers of living water.”[8]

39 But he said this about the Spirit, which those believing in him were to receive. For the Holy Spirit was not yet given, because Jesus wasn’t yet glorified.[9]

40 Many of the multitude therefore, when they heard these words, said, “This is truly the prophet.”[10]

41 Others said, “This is the Christ.” But some said, “What, does the Christ come out of Galilee?

42 Hasn’t the Scripture said that the Christ comes of the offspring of David, and from Bethlehem, the village where David was?”[11]

43 So there arose a division in the multitude because of him.

44 Some of them would have arrested him, but no one laid hands on him.

45 The officers therefore came to the chief priests and Pharisees, and they said to them, “Why didn’t you bring him?”

46 The officers answered, “No man ever spoke like this man!”[12]

47 The Pharisees therefore answered them, “You aren’t also led astray, are you?

48 Have any of the rulers believed in him, or of the Pharisees?

49 But this multitude that doesn’t know the law is accursed.”

50 Nicodemus (he who came to him by night, being one of them) said to them,

51 “Does our law judge a man, unless it first hears from him personally and knows what he does?”[13]

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[7] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:36 • Isaiah 55:1 - *the eighth day a holy convocation and solemn assembly, and come, everyone who thirsts, to the waters*

[8] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 14:8 • Ezekiel 47:1 - *living waters going out from Jerusalem in summer and winter, and waters flowing from under the threshold of the house*

[9] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Joel 2:28 • Isaiah 44:3 - *I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh, and water on the thirsty and my Spirit on your descendants*

[10] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:15 - *a prophet like Moses raised up from among you, to whom you shall listen*

[11] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Micah 5:2 • 2 Samuel 7:12 - *the ruler of Israel coming out of Bethlehem Ephrathah, and David’s offspring whose kingdom Yahweh establishes*

[12] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 45:2 • Isaiah 50:4 - *grace has anointed your lips, and the tongue of those who are taught, to sustain the weary with words*

[13] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 1:16-17 • Deuteronomy 17:4 - *hear cases between your brothers and judge righteously, and inquire diligently before anything is judged*

52 They answered him, “Are you also from Galilee? Search, and see that no prophet has arisen out of Galilee.”[14]

53 Everyone went to his own house,

[14] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Kings 14:25 • Joshua 19:13 - *Jonah the son of Amittai, the prophet from Gath Hepher, a town in the territory of Zebulun*

CHAPTER 8 - Stones Dropped in the Temple Court, the Light of the World, and Before Abraham, I AM

Key Notes

- He went to the Mount of Olives and came back to the temple at dawn. That is the pattern the other Gospels give for His final week, which is one reason many think this story belongs to that week (John 8:1-2, Luke 21:37-38).
- The scribes and Pharisees bring a woman caught in the act. If she was caught in the act, the man was caught too. The Torah required both to die. They brought only one (John 8:3-4, Leviticus 20:10, Deuteronomy 22:22).
- The trap was precise. Say no, and He contradicts Moses. Say yes, and He defies Rome, which reserved the death penalty for itself (John 8:5-6, 18:31).
- He stooped and wrote on the ground with His finger. The tablets of the covenant were written with the finger of God. And Jeremiah says those who turn from Yahweh will be written in the earth (John 8:6, Exodus 31:18, Jeremiah 17:13).
- What He wrote is never told. Every guess, including the popular one that He wrote their sins, is a guess (John 8:6, 8:8).
- “He who is without sin among you, let him throw the first stone at her.” Under the Torah the witnesses threw first. He did not abolish the penalty. He asked who was qualified to begin it (John 8:7, Deuteronomy 17:7).
- They left one by one, beginning from the oldest. The older you are, the longer the list (John 8:9).
- “Neither do I condemn you. Go your way. From now on, sin no more.” Both halves matter, and in that order. He does not condemn her, and He does not call it nothing (John 8:11).
- “I am the light of the world.” At Tabernacles, according to later Jewish accounts, huge lamps were lit in the Court of the Women, bright enough to light the whole city. Verse 20 places Him in the treasury, which was in that same court (John 8:12, 8:20).
- “Will not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life” recalls the pillar of fire in the wilderness - the light Israel followed, which the feast of booths remembers (John 8:12, Exodus 13:21).
- Their objection is a legal one: you testify about yourself, so your testimony is not valid. He answers with the Torah’s own rule of two witnesses - Himself and the Father (John 8:13, 8:17-18, Deuteronomy 19:15).
- “Unless you believe that I am he, you will die in your sins.” The word he is not in the Greek. It reads: unless you believe that I am. Isaiah uses the same words for Yahweh: that you may know and believe me, and understand that I am he (John 8:24, Isaiah 43:10).
- “When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am he.” The cross will be the place where who He is becomes plain - lifted up, like the serpent on the pole (John 8:28, 3:14).

- “You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free” is said to people who had just believed - and within twenty verses they are calling Him demon-possessed. Belief that will not stay is the subject of this whole exchange (John 8:31-32, 8:48).
- “We have never been in bondage to anyone.” Egypt, Assyria, Babylon, Persia, Greece, and the Roman soldiers standing outside the temple at that moment would beg to differ (John 8:33, Deuteronomy 6:21).
- “Everyone who commits sin is the bondservant of sin.” The slavery He means is not political (John 8:34).
- “A bondservant doesn’t live in the house forever. A son remains forever.” Ishmael and Isaac. Sarah’s words - cast out the servant and her son - stand behind the saying (John 8:35, Genesis 21:10).
- “If you were Abraham’s children, you would do the works of Abraham.” Descent is not the same as likeness. Abraham welcomed messengers from God; they want to kill one (John 8:39-40).
- “We were not born of sexual immorality” may be a jab. The rumors about His own birth were already going around (John 8:41).
- “He was a murderer from the beginning” goes back to the garden and the lie that brought death, and to Cain, the first murderer, who John later says was of the evil one (John 8:44, Genesis 3:4, 1 John 3:12).
- “Which of you convicts me of sin?” No one answers. In a crowd that wanted Him dead, no one could name a single thing (John 8:46).
- “You are a Samaritan, and have a demon” - the two worst things they could think to call Him, in one breath (John 8:48).
- “If a person keeps my word, he will never see death.” They hear it as madness, because Abraham died and the prophets died (John 8:51-53).
- “Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day.” On the mountain, when Abraham said God will provide the lamb, and named the place Yahweh Will Provide, he was looking further than he knew (John 8:56, Genesis 22:8, 22:14).
- “You are not yet fifty years old” is not a guess at His age. It is the age at which a Levite retired from service - a round number for a man not yet old (John 8:57, Numbers 4:3).
- “Before Abraham came into existence, I AM.” Not I was, which would claim age. I am, which claims something else. Abraham came to be; He simply is (John 8:58, Exodus 3:14).
- They picked up stones. The Torah’s penalty for blasphemy was stoning. They understood exactly what He had claimed (John 8:59, Leviticus 24:16).
- “Jesus was hidden, and went out of the temple.” In Ezekiel, the glory of Yahweh left the temple and went to the mountain on the east. John lets the picture stand without comment (John 8:59, Ezekiel 10:18, 11:23).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Both Shall Die	John 8:5 • Leviticus 20:10 • Deuteronomy 22:22
Written With His Finger	John 8:6 • Exodus 31:18 • Jeremiah 17:13
The Witnesses Throw First	John 8:7 • Deuteronomy 17:7
The Pillar of Fire	John 8:12 • Exodus 13:21 • Psalm 27:1
The Testimony of Two	John 8:17 • Deuteronomy 19:15
Never in Bondage?	John 8:33 • Deuteronomy 6:21 • Nehemiah 9:36
The Son Remains in the House	John 8:35 • Genesis 21:10 • Galatians 4:30
Stoning for Blasphemy	John 8:59 • Leviticus 24:16

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
The Light of the World	John 8:12 • Isaiah 9:2 • Isaiah 42:6
That I Am He	John 8:24 • Isaiah 43:10 • Deuteronomy 32:39
Lifted Up	John 8:28 • Isaiah 52:13 • Numbers 21:9
Liberty for the Captives	John 8:32 • Isaiah 61:1 • Psalm 119:45
No Deceit in His Mouth	John 8:46 • Isaiah 53:9 • Psalm 45:7
The Day Abraham Saw	John 8:56 • Genesis 22:8 • Genesis 22:14
Before Abraham, I AM	John 8:58 • Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 41:4
The Glory Leaves the Temple	John 8:59 • Ezekiel 10:18 • Ezekiel 11:23

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 8 Commentary (David Guzik) - the woman taken in adultery, the light of the world, and before Abraham was, I AM
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 8A - exposition of the light of the world and the children of Abraham

John 8 - Opening Intro

This chapter starts at dawn, in the temple court, with a crowd gathered around Him while He teaches.

And a group of scribes and Pharisees push through the crowd dragging a woman. And they stand her in the middle of everybody.

Teacher, this woman was caught in adultery. In the act.

Now stop right there. If she was caught in the act, where is the man?

The Torah says both of them die. Leviticus 20. Deuteronomy 22. The man and the woman. They brought one.

Which tells you this was never about the Torah. She was bait.

Because look at the trap. Moses says stone her. What do you say?

If He says do not stone her, He is against Moses. If He says stone her, He is defying Rome, because Rome did not let the Jews carry out executions. Either answer and they have Him.

And He does not answer. He bends down and starts writing in the dirt with His finger.

With His finger. Do you remember what else was written by the finger of God? The tablets on Mount Sinai. The same finger that wrote the commandments is now writing in the dust of the temple court.

And Jeremiah says something chilling. Those who turn away from Yahweh will be written in the earth. We are not told what He wrote. But we know what Jeremiah said gets written in the dirt.

They keep pushing. And He stands up and says one sentence. Whoever among you is without sin, let him throw the first stone.

And in the Torah, the witnesses threw first. So He did not cancel the penalty. He just asked who was qualified to start.

And He bends down and writes some more.

And one by one they walk away. Beginning with the oldest.

Of course the oldest. They have had the longest to collect a list.

And then it is just Him and her. And He says: woman, where are your accusers? Has nobody condemned you? No one, Lord. Neither do I condemn you. Go, and from now on sin no more.

Both halves. In that order. He does not condemn her - and He does not tell her it does not matter.

Some of you only ever heard the first half. Some of you only ever heard the second half. You need both.

Then He turns to the crowd and says: I am the light of the world.

And John tells us exactly where He was standing when He said it - by the treasury. That was in the Court of the Women. And during Tabernacles, that court had enormous lamps that were lit at night, so bright people said the whole city glowed.

He is standing next to the biggest lamps in Jerusalem saying: I am the light.

And then the conversation gets harder and harder. He tells them: unless you believe that I am, you will die in your sins. And the word He uses is the same word God uses in Isaiah. That you may know and believe that I am He.

And some of them believe. And He says to the ones who believe: if you keep My word, you are truly My disciples, and you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.

And immediately they are offended. Free? We are children of Abraham. We have never been slaves to anybody.

Never been slaves? Egypt. Babylon. And Roman soldiers standing guard outside the very building they are standing in.

And He says: whoever sins is a slave to sin. A slave does not stay in the house forever. A son stays forever. So if the Son sets you free, you are free indeed.

And it keeps escalating. Abraham is our father. Then do what Abraham did. God is our Father. If God were your Father, you would love Me. And then the hardest thing He ever says to anybody. You are of your father the devil.

And He says: which one of you can convict Me of a single sin?

And nobody says anything. In a crowd that wanted Him dead, nobody could name one thing.

Then He says: if anybody keeps My word, he will never see death. And they say: now we know You have a demon. Abraham died. The prophets died. Who do You think You are?

And He says: your father Abraham rejoiced to see My day. He saw it, and was glad.

And they laugh. You are not even fifty years old and You have seen Abraham?

And He says: Most certainly, I tell you, before Abraham came into existence, I AM.

Not I was. I AM. Abraham had a beginning. He does not.

And they picked up stones. Because the Torah says the blasphemer is stoned. They knew exactly what He had just claimed.

And He hid Himself and walked out of the temple.

Before we read - notice that the chapter opens with men holding stones they did not throw, and ends with men holding stones they could not throw. Ask which group you have been in.

John 8:1-59 (WEB)

1 but Jesus went to the Mount of Olives.

2 Now very early in the morning, he came again into the temple, and all the people came to him. He sat down, and taught them.

3 The scribes and the Pharisees brought a woman taken in adultery. Having set her in the middle,

4 they told him, “Teacher, we found this woman in adultery, in the very act.

5 Now in our law, Moses commanded us to stone such women. What then do you say about her?”[15]

6 They said this testing him, that they might have something to accuse him of. But Jesus stooped down, and wrote on the ground with his finger.[16]

7 But when they continued asking him, he looked up and said to them, “He who is without sin among you, let him throw the first stone at her.”[17]

8 Again he stooped down, and with his finger wrote on the ground.

9 They, when they heard it, being convicted by their conscience, went out one by one, beginning from the oldest, even to the last. Jesus was left alone with the woman where she was, in the middle.

10 Jesus, standing up, saw her and said, “Woman, where are your accusers? Did no one condemn you?”

11 She said, “No one, Lord.” Jesus said, “Neither do I condemn you. Go your way. From now on, sin no more.”

12 Again, therefore, Jesus spoke to them, saying, “I am the light of the world. He who follows me will not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life.”[18]

13 The Pharisees therefore said to him, “You testify about yourself. Your testimony is not valid.”

14 Jesus answered them, “Even if I testify about myself, my testimony is true, for I know where I came from, and where I am going; but you don’t know where I came from, or where I am going.

15 You judge according to the flesh. I judge no one.

16 Even if I do judge, my judgment is true, for I am not alone, but I am with the Father who sent me.

17 It’s also written in your law that the testimony of two people is valid.[19]

18 I am one who testifies about myself, and the Father who sent me testifies about me.”

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[15] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 20:10 • Deuteronomy 22:22 - *the adulterer and the adulteress both put to death, the man who lay with the woman and the woman*

[16] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 31:18 • Jeremiah 17:13 - *the tablets written with God’s finger, and those who depart from Yahweh written in the earth*

[17] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 17:7 - *the hand of the witnesses first on him to put him to death, and afterward the hand of all the people*

[18] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 9:2 • Isaiah 42:6 - *the people in darkness seeing a great light, and the servant given as a light for the nations*

[19] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 19:15 - *every matter established at the mouth of two or three witnesses*

19 They said therefore to him, “Where is your Father?” Jesus answered, “You know neither me, nor my Father. If you knew me, you would know my Father also.”

20 Jesus spoke these words in the treasury, as he taught in the temple. Yet no one arrested him, because his hour had not yet come.

21 Jesus said therefore again to them, “I am going away, and you will seek me, and you will die in your sins. Where I go, you can’t come.”

22 The Jews therefore said, “Will he kill himself, because he says, ‘Where I am going, you can’t come’?”

23 He said to them, “You are from beneath. I am from above. You are of this world. I am not of this world.

24 I said therefore to you that you will die in your sins; for unless you believe that I am he, you will die in your sins.”[20]

25 They said therefore to him, “Who are you?” Jesus said to them, “Just what I have been saying to you from the beginning.

26 I have many things to speak and to judge concerning you. However he who sent me is true; and the things which I heard from him, these I say to the world.”

27 They didn’t understand that he spoke to them about the Father.

28 Jesus therefore said to them, “When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am he, and I do nothing of myself, but as my Father taught me, I say these things.[21]

29 He who sent me is with me. The Father hasn’t left me alone, for I always do the things that are pleasing to him.”

30 As he spoke these things, many believed in him.

31 Jesus therefore said to those Jews who had believed him, “If you remain in my word, then you are truly my disciples.

32 You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free.”[22]

33 They answered him, “We are Abraham’s offspring, and have never been in bondage to anyone. How do you say, ‘You will be made free’?”[23]

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[20] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 43:10 • Deuteronomy 32:39 - *that you may know and believe me and understand that I am he, and see now that I myself am he*

[21] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 52:13 • Numbers 21:9 - *my servant exalted and lifted up, and the bronze serpent on the pole that whoever looked at lived*

[22] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 61:1 • Psalm 119:45 - *liberty proclaimed to the captives, and I will walk in liberty, for I have sought your precepts*

[23] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 6:21 • Nehemiah 9:36 - *we were Pharaoh’s slaves in Egypt, and we are servants today in the land you gave our fathers*

34 Jesus answered them, “Most certainly I tell you, everyone who commits sin is the bondservant of sin.

35 A bondservant doesn’t live in the house forever. A son remains forever.[24]

36 If therefore the Son makes you free, you will be free indeed.

37 I know that you are Abraham’s offspring, yet you seek to kill me, because my word finds no place in you.

38 I say the things which I have seen with my Father; and you also do the things which you have seen with your father.”

39 They answered him, “Our father is Abraham.” Jesus said to them, “If you were Abraham’s children, you would do the works of Abraham.

40 But now you seek to kill me, a man who has told you the truth, which I heard from God. Abraham didn’t do this.

41 You do the works of your father.” They said to him, “We were not born of sexual immorality. We have one Father, God.”

42 Therefore Jesus said to them, “If God were your father, you would love me, for I came out and have come from God. For I haven’t come of myself, but he sent me.

43 Why don’t you understand my speech? Because you can’t hear my word.

44 You are of your father, the devil, and you want to do the desires of your father. He was a murderer from the beginning, and doesn’t stand in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaks a lie, he speaks on his own; for he is a liar, and the father of lies.

45 But because I tell the truth, you don’t believe me.

46 Which of you convicts me of sin? If I tell the truth, why do you not believe me?[25]

47 He who is of God hears the words of God. For this cause you don’t hear, because you are not of God.”

48 Then the Jews answered him, “Don’t we say well that you are a Samaritan, and have a demon?”

49 Jesus answered, “I don’t have a demon, but I honor my Father, and you dishonor me.

50 But I don’t seek my own glory. There is one who seeks and judges.

51 Most certainly, I tell you, if a person keeps my word, he will never see death.”

52 Then the Jews said to him, “Now we know that you have a demon. Abraham died, and the prophets; and you say, ‘If a man keeps my word, he will never taste of death.’

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[24] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 21:10 • Galatians 4:30 - *cast out the servant and her son, for the son of the servant will not be heir with Isaac*

[25] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:9 • Psalm 45:7 - *he had done no violence and there was no deceit in his mouth, and you have loved righteousness and hated wickedness*

53 Are you greater than our father, Abraham, who died? The prophets died. Who do you make yourself out to be?"

54 Jesus answered, "If I glorify myself, my glory is nothing. It is my Father who glorifies me, of whom you say that he is our God.

55 You have not known him, but I know him. If I said, 'I don't know him,' I would be like you, a liar. But I know him, and keep his word.

56 Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day. He saw it, and was glad."[26]

57 The Jews therefore said to him, "You are not yet fifty years old, and have you seen Abraham?"

58 Jesus said to them, "Most certainly, I tell you, before Abraham came into existence, I AM."[27]

59 Therefore they took up stones to throw at him, but Jesus was hidden, and went out of the temple, having gone through the middle of them, and so passed by.[28]

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[26] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Genesis 22:8 • Genesis 22:14 - *God will provide himself the lamb, and the place named Yahweh Will Provide*

[27] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 41:4 - *I AM WHO I AM, and I, Yahweh, the first, and with the last, I am he*

[28] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 10:18 • Ezekiel 11:23 - *Yahweh's glory going out from the threshold of the house and standing on the mountain east of the city*

CHAPTER 9 - A Man Born Blind, Mud and a Pool Called Sent, and the Ones Who Could Not See

Key Notes

- He saw a man blind from birth. In this Gospel He keeps noticing people first. The man never asked for anything (John 9:1).
- “Who sinned, this man or his parents?” Both options had defenders. The commandment speaks of iniquity visited on the children of those who hate Him; Ezekiel says the son will not bear the father’s iniquity (John 9:2, Exodus 20:5, Ezekiel 18:20).
- “Neither did this man sin, nor his parents.” He rejects the whole question. Not every suffering is a sentence (John 9:3, 5:14).
- “That the works of God might be revealed in him” can be punctuated differently, since the Greek had no punctuation: neither he nor his parents sinned. But so that the works of God may be revealed, we must work. Either way, the blindness is not a punishment (John 9:3-4).
- “I must work the works of him who sent me while it is day.” The WEB reads I; many of the oldest manuscripts read we must work, which takes the disciples into the work with Him (John 9:4).
- He spat on the ground and made mud. God formed man from the dust of the ground. The one who made eyes the first time uses the same material the second time (John 9:6, Genesis 2:7).
- Siloam means Sent. It was the pool at the bottom of the city, fed by the waters of Shiloah that Isaiah says the people refused - the same pool the water came from at the feast two chapters earlier (John 9:7, Isaiah 8:6).
- He went, washed, and came back seeing. He had to walk to the pool blind, with mud on his face, on nothing but a word (John 9:7).
- The neighbors cannot agree whether it is even the same man. Some say yes, some say it looks like him. A changed life is often harder for people to accept than a miracle (John 9:8-9).
- “It was a Sabbath” - again held back until after the healing, as in chapter 5. Kneading clay was one of the forms of work later listed as forbidden on the Sabbath. The Torah’s own command is to do no regular work and to keep the day holy (John 9:14, 5:9).
- The Pharisees split: he is not from God because he does not keep the Sabbath; how can a sinner do such signs? The miracle forced a choice they did not want to make (John 9:16).
- “He is a prophet” is the man’s first answer. Watch him move: a man called Jesus, then a prophet, then from God, then Lord, then worship (John 9:11, 9:17, 9:33, 9:38).
- His parents confirm the facts and refuse anything else: he is of age, ask him. They feared being put out of the synagogue, a word found only in John (John 9:20-22, 12:42, 16:2).
- “Give glory to God” was a solemn charge to tell the truth and confess. Joshua said it to Achan before Achan admitted his sin (John 9:24, Joshua 7:19).

- “One thing I do know: that though I was blind, now I see.” He cannot answer their theology. He can answer from experience, and they have no reply to that (John 9:25).
- “You don’t also want to become his disciples, do you?” The word also means the blind beggar already counts himself one (John 9:27).
- “We are disciples of Moses. We know that God has spoken to Moses.” Moses saw God face to face, and Moses wrote about the one standing in front of them (John 9:28-29, Deuteronomy 34:10, 5:46).
- “We know that God doesn’t listen to sinners” is the man quoting their own theology back at them, and he is right. Yahweh is far from the wicked but hears the prayer of the righteous (John 9:31, Proverbs 15:29).
- “Since the world began it has never been heard of that anyone opened the eyes of someone born blind.” The Hebrew Scriptures record no such miracle. Psalm 146 says it is something Yahweh does (John 9:32, Psalm 146:8).
- “You were altogether born in sins, and do you teach us?” They answer the logic with an insult and throw him out (John 9:34).
- “Jesus heard that they had thrown him out, and finding him…” Thrown out by men, found by Him. He went looking (John 9:35).
- “Who is he, Lord, that I may believe in him?” The man has never seen Yahshua. He went to the pool blind and came back to find Him gone (John 9:36).
- “You have both seen him, and it is he who speaks with you.” The first face the man ever looked at with understanding was His (John 9:37).
- “He worshiped him.” The same word used for worship given to God. Yahshua does not stop him (John 9:38).
- “I came into this world for judgment, that those who don’t see may see, and that those who see may become blind” is Isaiah’s commission running in both directions at once (John 9:39, Isaiah 6:9-10, 29:18).
- “If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now you say, ‘We see.’ Therefore your sin remains.” The blindness that cannot be healed is the kind that insists it can see (John 9:41).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Who Sinned?	John 9:2 • Exodus 20:5 • Ezekiel 18:20
Formed From the Dust	John 9:6 • Genesis 2:7 • Isaiah 64:8
The Waters of Shiloah	John 9:7 • Isaiah 8:6 • Nehemiah 3:15
Give Glory to God	John 9:24 • Joshua 7:19
Disciples of Moses	John 9:28 • Deuteronomy 34:10 • Numbers 12:7-8
God Hears the Righteous	John 9:31 • Psalm 66:18 • Proverbs 15:29

Topic	References
Cast Out for His Name	John 9:34 • Isaiah 66:5
Eyes That Do Not See	John 9:39 • Isaiah 6:9-10 • Jeremiah 5:21

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
A Light for the Nations	John 9:5 • Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 60:1
The Eyes of the Blind Opened	John 9:7 • Isaiah 35:5 • Isaiah 42:7
The One Who Was Sent	John 9:7 • Isaiah 61:1 • Isaiah 48:16
Never Heard Since the World Began	John 9:32 • Psalm 146:8 • Isaiah 64:4
Honor Him, for He Is Your Lord	John 9:38 • Psalm 45:11 • Psalm 2:12
The Blind Will See Out of Darkness	John 9:39 • Isaiah 29:18 • Isaiah 42:16

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 9 Commentary (David Guzik) - the healing of the man born blind and the blindness of the Pharisees
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 9A - exposition of the man born blind and the questions that followed

John 9 - Opening Intro

This chapter is one of the funniest and saddest stories in the whole Bible, and it is all about who can see.

Yahshua is walking along and He sees a man who has been blind since the day he was born. The man does not call out. He does not ask for anything. Yahshua just sees him.

And the disciples look at the same man and see a theology question. Rabbi, who sinned - this man or his parents - that he was born blind?

Now they had verses for both sides. The commandment talks about the iniquity of the fathers visited on the children. Ezekiel says the son will not bear the father's sin. So they want Him to settle the debate.

And He throws out the whole question. Neither. This man did not sin and neither did his parents.

Some of us need to hear that. Not everything wrong in your life is a punishment.

Then He spits on the ground, makes mud, and puts it on the man's eyes.

Now why mud? Think about Genesis. God formed man from the dust of the ground. The same hands that made eyes out of dirt the first time are making them out of dirt again.

And He says: go wash in the pool of Siloam. And John translates it for us - Siloam means Sent.

And think about what that man has to do. He has to get up and walk all the way down to the bottom of the city, blind, with mud smeared on his face, on nothing but a word.

And he goes. And he washes. And he comes back seeing.

And now the comedy starts. His neighbors cannot even agree it is him. Is that the beggar? No, it just looks like him. And he keeps saying: it is me! I am the guy!

So they drag him to the Pharisees. And then John drops the line: it was the Sabbath.

And the Pharisees split right down the middle. This man is not from God - he does not keep the Sabbath. But how can a sinner do signs like this?

So they ask the blind man what he thinks. And he says: He is a prophet.

Then they call in his parents. Is this your son? Was he born blind? How does he see now? And the parents are terrified, because anybody who confessed Yahshua was going to be thrown out of the synagogue. So they say: yes, that is our son, yes, he was born blind - how he sees, we have no idea. Ask him. He is a grown man.

So they call the man back in a second time. Give glory to God - which is what you say when you want somebody to confess. Joshua said it to Achan. We know this man is a sinner.

And the man gives the greatest answer in the chapter. Whether He is a sinner, I do not know. One thing I do know. I was blind, and now I see.

You can argue with a lot of things. You cannot argue with that.

And they keep pushing - how did He do it, tell us again - and the man has had enough. I already told you and you did not listen. Why do you want to hear it again? You do not want to become His disciples too, do you?

Too. The beggar is already calling himself a disciple.

And they lose it. You are His disciple. We are disciples of Moses. We know God spoke to Moses. This man - we do not even know where He comes from.

And the blind beggar starts teaching the theologians. Well, that is amazing. You do not know where He comes from, and He opened my eyes. We know God does not listen to sinners. Since the world began nobody has ever heard of a man born blind getting his sight. If this man were not from God, He could do nothing.

And they have no answer, so they insult him and throw him out.

And here is my favorite line in the chapter. Yahshua heard they had thrown him out, and He went and found him.

Thrown out by men. Found by Him.

And remember - this man has never actually seen Yahshua. He went to the pool blind. When he came back, Yahshua was gone. So Yahshua asks: do you believe in the Son of Man? And he says: who is He, Lord, so I can believe in Him?

And Yahshua says: you have seen Him. He is the one talking with you.

And the man says: Lord, I believe. And he worshipped Him.

Watch how far he went in one chapter. A man called Jesus. Then a prophet. Then from God. Then Lord. Then worship.

And the chapter ends with Yahshua saying: I came so that the blind would see - and the ones who see would become blind. And the Pharisees say: are we blind too? And He says: if you were blind, you would have no sin. But since you say we see, your sin remains.

Before we read - the man who could not see ended up worshipping, and the men who could see ended up blind. The only blindness He cannot heal is the kind that insists it can see.

John 9:1-41 (WEB)

1 As he passed by, he saw a man blind from birth.

2 His disciples asked him, “Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?”[29]

3 Jesus answered, “Neither did this man sin, nor his parents; but, that the works of God might be revealed in him.

4 I must work the works of him who sent me, while it is day. The night is coming, when no one can work.

5 While I am in the world, I am the light of the world.”[30]

6 When he had said this, he spat on the ground, made mud with the saliva, anointed the blind man’s eyes with the mud,[31]

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[29] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 20:5 • Ezekiel 18:20 - *iniquity visited on the children of those who hate him, and the son shall not bear the iniquity of the father*

[30] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 60:1 - *a light to the nations so salvation reaches the end of the earth, and arise, shine, for your light has come*

[31] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 2:7 • Isaiah 64:8 - *Yahweh God forming man from the dust of the ground, and we are the clay and you our potter*

7 and said to him, “Go, wash in the pool of Siloam” (which means “Sent”). So he went away, washed, and came back seeing.[32,33]

8 The neighbors therefore, and those who saw that he was blind before, said, “Isn’t this he who sat and begged?”

9 Others were saying, “It is he.” Still others were saying, “He looks like him.” He said, “I am he.”

10 They therefore were asking him, “How were your eyes opened?”

11 He answered, “A man called Jesus made mud, anointed my eyes, and said to me, ‘Go to the pool of Siloam, and wash.’ So I went away and washed, and I received sight.”

12 Then they asked him, “Where is he?” He said, “I don’t know.”

13 They brought him who had been blind to the Pharisees.

14 It was a Sabbath when Jesus made the mud and opened his eyes.

15 Again therefore the Pharisees also asked him how he received his sight. He said to them, “He put mud on my eyes, I washed, and I see.”

16 Some therefore of the Pharisees said, “This man is not from God, because he doesn’t keep the Sabbath.” Others said, “How can a man who is a sinner do such signs?” There was division among them.

17 Therefore they asked the blind man again, “What do you say about him, because he opened your eyes?” He said, “He is a prophet.”

18 The Jews therefore did not believe concerning him, that he had been blind, and had received his sight, until they called the parents of him who had received his sight,

19 and asked them, “Is this your son, whom you say was born blind? How then does he now see?”

20 His parents answered them, “We know that this is our son, and that he was born blind;

21 but how he now sees, we don’t know; or who opened his eyes, we don’t know. He is of age. Ask him. He will speak for himself.”

22 His parents said these things because they feared the Jews; for the Jews had already agreed that if any man would confess him as Christ, he would be put out of the synagogue.

23 Therefore his parents said, “He is of age. Ask him.”

24 So they called the man who was blind a second time, and said to him, “Give glory to God. We know that this man is a sinner.”[34]

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[32] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 35:5 • Isaiah 61:1 - *the eyes of the blind opened, and the Lord Yahweh’s anointed one sent to the brokenhearted and the captives*

[33] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 8:6 - *the waters of Shiloah that go softly, refused by the people*

[34] **Cross-Reference:** Joshua 7:19 - *Joshua telling Achan to give glory to Yahweh and confess what he had done*

25 He therefore answered, “I don’t know if he is a sinner. One thing I do know: that though I was blind, now I see.”

26 They said to him again, “What did he do to you? How did he open your eyes?”

27 He answered them, “I told you already, and you didn’t listen. Why do you want to hear it again? You don’t also want to become his disciples, do you?”

28 They insulted him and said, “You are his disciple, but we are disciples of Moses.[35]

29 We know that God has spoken to Moses. But as for this man, we don’t know where he comes from.”

30 The man answered them, “How amazing! You don’t know where he comes from, yet he opened my eyes.

31 We know that God doesn’t listen to sinners, but if anyone is a worshiper of God, and does his will, he listens to him.[36]

32 Since the world began it has never been heard of that anyone opened the eyes of someone born blind.[37]

33 If this man were not from God, he could do nothing.”

34 They answered him, “You were altogether born in sins, and do you teach us?” They threw him out.[38]

35 Jesus heard that they had thrown him out, and finding him, he said, “Do you believe in the Son of God?”

36 He answered, “Who is he, Lord, that I may believe in him?”

37 Jesus said to him, “You have both seen him, and it is he who speaks with you.”

38 He said, “Lord, I believe!” and he worshiped him.[39]

39 Jesus said, “I came into this world for judgment, that those who don’t see may see; and that those who see may become blind.”[40,41]

40 Those of the Pharisees who were with him heard these things, and said to him, “Are we also blind?”

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[35] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 34:10 • Numbers 12:7-8 - *no prophet like Moses whom Yahweh knew face to face, spoken to mouth to mouth and not in riddles*

[36] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 66:18 • Proverbs 15:29 - *if I cherished sin in my heart the Lord would not have listened, and he hears the prayer of the righteous*

[37] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 146:8 • Isaiah 64:4 - *Yahweh opens the eyes of the blind, and from of old no eye has seen a God besides you*

[38] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 66:5 - *your brothers who hate you and cast you out for my name’s sake will be disappointed*

[39] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 45:11 • Psalm 2:12 - *honor him, for he is your lord, and homage given to the Son*

[40] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 29:18 • Isaiah 42:16 - *the eyes of the blind seeing out of obscurity and darkness, and the blind led by a way they do not know*

[41] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 6:9-10 - *seeing indeed but not perceiving, eyes shut lest they see and turn and be healed*

41 Jesus said to them, “If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now you say, ‘We see.’ Therefore your sin remains.

Major Themes Across John 7-9

- Brothers at the same table who did not believe, and one of them who later did
- A time that is never ready for Him and always ready for those it costs nothing
- Whispers in the city and no one willing to speak openly
- Understanding that follows obedience rather than preceding it
- Accused of breaking the Sabbath by men plotting murder
- Circumcision on the eighth day, and a whole man made well
- Judging by appearance instead of with righteous judgment
- A shout on the last day of the water feast
- Rivers of living water flowing from the one standing in the temple
- Officers sent to arrest Him who were arrested by what they heard
- Nicodemus speaking up in daylight, and paying for it
- Experts so angry they forgot Jonah came from Galilee
- A woman used as bait, and a man who was never brought
- The finger that wrote the tablets, writing in the dust
- Stones dropped one by one, beginning with the oldest
- Neither do I condemn you, and go and sin no more, kept together
- The light of the world, spoken beside the great lamps of the feast
- I am, in Isaiah's words, and dying in sin for refusing it
- Truth that makes free, offered to people who insisted they were never slaves
- A son who stays in the house, and a slave who does not
- Descent from Abraham without likeness to him
- No one in a hostile crowd able to name a single sin
- Abraham rejoicing to see a day he could only see from far off
- Before Abraham came to be, I AM
- Stones lifted by men who understood the claim perfectly
- A man noticed before he asked for anything
- Suffering that is not a sentence
- Eyes made from dust a second time by the hands that made them the first
- A walk to a pool called Sent, blind, on nothing but a word
- Neighbors who could not accept a changed life
- One thing I know: I was blind and now I see
- A beggar who already counted himself a disciple

- Thrown out by men and found by Him
- From a man called Jesus to Lord, I believe, and worship
- The only blindness that cannot be healed is the kind that says it sees

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May we keep believing for the ones at our own table who do not believe yet.

May we move in His time and not in the time that costs us nothing.

May we be willing to do His will, and so come to know His teaching.

May we never defend a commandment while breaking a greater one.

May we judge with righteous judgment and not by appearance.

May we come to Him thirsty, and drink.

May rivers of living water flow out of us to a dry world.

May we be arrested by His words and not by the opinions of men.

May we speak up in daylight, even if all we have is one sentence.

May we put down every stone we were holding for someone else.

May we hear both halves: neither do I condemn you, and sin no more.

May we follow the light of the world and not walk in darkness.

May we believe that He is, and not die in our sins.

May we know the truth, and be made free indeed.

May we stop pretending we were never slaves.

May we do the works of Abraham and not only claim his name.

May we see His day, as Abraham did, and rejoice.

May we bow before the One who was before Abraham.

May we see people before we see questions.

May we stop assuming every suffering is a sentence.

May we let Him form our eyes again from the dust.

May we walk to the pool on nothing but His word.

May we answer every argument with what He has done.

May we be found by Him when we are thrown out by others.

May we say, Lord, I believe, and worship Him.

May we never say we see while refusing to look.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.